

Teacher-student dialogue (Topic: IKEA Effect)

Teacher:

Student:

今天我们来探讨一个非常有趣的心理学现象，叫做宜家效应，你听说过这个名字吗？

Today, we are going to explore a very interesting psychological phenomenon called the IKEA effect. Have you heard of this name before?

宜家效应好像听过宜家家具品牌，但效应是什么意思？

I have heard of IKEA as a furniture brand, but what does the effect mean?

很好，效应就是某种心理或行为的影响，宜家效应指的是人们对自己亲手做的东西会感觉更有价值，甚至比别人做得更好，还要喜欢。

Good question. An effect refers to a certain psychological or behavioral influence. The IKEA effect means that people tend to perceive things they have made by themselves as more valuable, and may even like them more than things made by others.

意思是说比如我自己组装的家具会觉得比买现成的更珍贵。

So it means that, for example, I might feel that furniture I assembled myself is more precious than furniture I bought ready-made.

完全正确，这就是宜家效应的核心。因为宜家家具通常需要自己组装，消费者在过程中投入了劳动和情感，所以对最终产品有更强的认同感。

Exactly. That is the core of the IKEA effect. Because IKEA furniture usually requires self-assembly, consumers invest labor and emotion in the process, which gives them a stronger sense of identification with the final product.

听起来好像挺合理的。这个现象是怎么被发现的呢？

That sounds quite reasonable. How was this phenomenon discovered?

这个效应是在 2011 年由哈佛和杜克大学的心理学家通过实验验证的，比如有个折纸实验参与者分成两组，一组自己折纸，另一组只是看别人折。

This effect was experimentally validated in 2011 by psychologists from Harvard and Duke University. For example, in an origami experiment, participants were divided

into two groups: one group folded origami themselves, while the other group only watched others fold it.

等一下那个实验是怎么进行的？折纸有什么特别的。

Wait, how exactly was that experiment conducted? What was special about origami?

参与者折了一个折纸作品后，大家都要对折好的作品估价，结果发现自己折纸的人对自己的作品估价几乎是旁观者的 5 倍，即使自己的作品比专业折纸师做的粗糙，他们还是更看重自己的作品。

After participants folded an origami object, everyone was asked to estimate the value of the finished work. The results showed that those who folded the origami themselves valued their own creations at almost five times the value given by observers. Even when their work was rougher than that of professional origami makers, they still valued it more highly.

这真有趣，我自己做的东西居然会觉得更值钱，哪怕它不完美，这是为什么。

That is really interesting. I would actually think something I made myself is more valuable, even if it is not perfect. Why does that happen?

这背后跟认知失调理论有关。简单来说，当我们为一件事付出努力后，大脑会自动调整我们的想法，让我们觉得这付出是值得的，从而提升对成果的价值感。

This is related to cognitive dissonance theory. Simply put, when we put effort into something, our brain automatically adjusts our thoughts to make us feel that the effort was worthwhile, thereby increasing our perceived value of the outcome.

听起来有点像给自己找理由，不让努力白费。

That sounds a bit like finding a reason for ourselves so that our effort does not feel wasted.

对，而且完成任务的成就感和心理所有权感，会让我们对这个东西产生更深的情感连接，它不仅是个物品，更像是战利品或能力证明。

Yes. Moreover, the sense of achievement and psychological ownership that comes from completing a task can create a deeper emotional connection with the object. It becomes not just an item, but more like a trophy or proof of one's ability.

这种效应是从什么时候开始出现的，小孩子也会有吗？

When does this effect begin to appear? Do children experience it too?

研究显示宜家效应大约在 5 岁左右开始出现，这正是自我概念形成的重要阶段。孩子开始理解，这是我做的这种心理所有权。

Research shows that the IKEA effect begins to appear around the age of five, which is an important stage in the development of self-concept. Children begin to understand the sense of psychological ownership expressed as “this is something I made.”

原来这么早就有这种心理了，这个效应有什么实际应用吗？比如设计方面。

So this kind of psychology appears that early. Does this effect have any practical applications, such as in design?

有的。宜家效应告诉我们，用户对产品的价值感是主观的，和他们的参与感密切相关，设计时可以让用户参与创造过程，增强他们的成就感。

Yes. The IKEA effect tells us that users’ perceived value of a product is subjective and closely related to their sense of participation. In design, users can be involved in the creation process to strengthen their sense of achievement.

比如说怎样才能让用户感觉自己是创造者呢？

For example, how can we make users feel that they are creators?

比如在 AI 助手里不只是提供答案，而是让用户能调整和定制内容，让人机协作，更像共创。

For example, in an AI assistant, the system should not merely provide answers, but allow users to adjust and customize the content, making human-AI collaboration feel more like co-creation.

健康管理 APP。我平时用的那些只让我拍照记录，好像挺被动的。

Health management apps, for instance. The ones I usually use only ask me to take photos and record information, which feels quite passive.

正是这样，设计可以引导用户主动参与目标设定、实物标记，甚至卡路里管理，增强投入感，从而提升持续使用的意愿。

Exactly. Design can guide users to actively participate in goal setting, physical marking, and even calorie management, increasing their sense of involvement and thereby improving their intention to continue using the app.

我明白了。这样用户会更有动力坚持下去。教育平台有没有类似的设计？

I see. In this way, users will be more motivated to keep going. Are there similar designs in educational platforms?

有的。教育平台可以根据学习进度推荐课程，但让学生自己选择学习路径，这样学生会有更强的掌控感和归属感。

Yes. Educational platforms can recommend courses based on learning progress, while still allowing students to choose their own learning paths. This gives students a stronger sense of control and belonging.

听起来宜家效应不仅是心理学现象，也能指导我们如何设计更好的产品和服务。

It sounds like the IKEA effect is not only a psychological phenomenon, but can also guide us in designing better products and services.

没错。通过激发用户的创造者身份，我们能提升用户体验，让产品更有价值。

Exactly. By activating users' identity as creators, we can improve the user experience and make products feel more valuable.

老师这让我想到，如果我写代码自己调试，也会觉得代码特别宝贝，是不是也是宜家效应？

Teacher, this reminds me: if I write code and debug it myself, I may feel that the code is especially precious. Is that also the IKEA effect?

完全对。无论是家具还是代码，只要你亲手参与，都会产生这种效应。

Absolutely. Whether it is furniture or code, as long as you personally participate in creating it, this effect can occur.

太有意思了，以后我做任何东西都会更珍惜了。谢谢老师。

That is really interesting. I will cherish anything I make even more in the future. Thank you, teacher.

不客气，希望你能把这个理念用到生活和学习中。

You're welcome. I hope you can apply this idea in your life and learning.